

## Prep Worksheet Instructions

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In the world of interviewing there is one sad, but inevitable truth – the person who is best for the job does not always get the job – the person who **interviews the best for the job gets the job!**

This interview prep worksheet is designed to specifically help you give the very best interview you can. In order to do that it's important you understand a little bit about what you will experience during an interview, because the number one reason why a candidate bombs an interview has nothing to do with their skills it has to do with how they prepare. During an interview, you will begin to feel a certain amount of stress. When you become stressed one of the first thing that happens is you will start to lose your ability to access your long-term memory (details about things that happen more than 18 months ago). Well right now the most popular style of interview being conducted is a "behavior based" interview – give me examples of what you've done in the past and it's a pretty good indicator of what you're going to do in the future. So, you are going to have an interviewer ask you for details about something on your resume from 3 years ago, and your brain just simply won't let you access those memories and the result is a long drawn out pause, and a filler statement like – "Boy that's a good question. Let me think about that a minute." As your thinking – the interviewer is equating that with a lack of real experience and ultimately a failed interview.

Well this worksheet is designed so that isn't what you're going to experience. Start with the left-hand side of the document. What you want to do first is go through your last 3 positions and write down every accomplishment you can remember from those 3 positions. Focus specifically on three areas – namely – where did you **MAKE** the company money? Where did you **SAVE** the company money? And finally, where did you **IMPROVE A PROCESS OR PROCEDURE**?

Once you've done that – focus on the right-hand side of the page. Look at each individual accomplishment and make some notes on what happened with that accomplishment. Specifically address these issues – whose buy-in did you have to get for the accomplishment? What hurdles did you have to overcome? Were you on time and on budget? What were your actual results vs. expected results? What would you do differently next time?

Once you've written all this down what you have successfully done is now moved all those details that were stored in your long-term memory and put them back in your short-term memory, so you can give better examples faster now during your interview. The result will be you'll give a much better interview. IF you are scheduled for a telephone interview feel free to have this sheet lying in front of you while you're talking on the phone.

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**REVIEWING YOUR PROFESSIONAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS** – Start with your most recent Employer – focus on the issues that will relate to this position.

**Company:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Position:** \_\_\_\_\_

List your Accomplishments/Achievements while working at this position here:

List the strategy, implementation, and development processes you used to bring about these results:

[illegible]

**Company:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Position:** \_\_\_\_\_

List your Accomplishments/Achievements while working at this position here:

List the strategy, implementation, and development processes you used to bring about these results:

[illegible]

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**Company:** \_\_\_\_\_

List your Accomplishments/Achievements while working at this position here:

This image shows a full page of handwriting practice paper. It features ten identical rows of horizontal guidelines. Each row is composed of three lines: a solid black line at the top, a dashed black line in the middle, and another solid black line at the bottom. These lines are evenly spaced across the entire page to help students learn letter height and placement. The background is white, and there are no other markings or text present.

**Position:** \_\_\_\_\_

List the strategy, implementation, and development processes you used to bring about these results:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There is a vertical margin line on the left side, creating a narrow left margin. The paper appears to be from a notebook or a standard ruled document.

**Company:** \_\_\_\_\_

List your Accomplishments/Achievements while working at this position here:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

**Position:** \_\_\_\_\_

List the strategy, implementation, and development processes you used to bring about these results:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. On the left side, there is a vertical margin line, creating a narrow left margin. The paper appears to be a standard notebook or ledger page.